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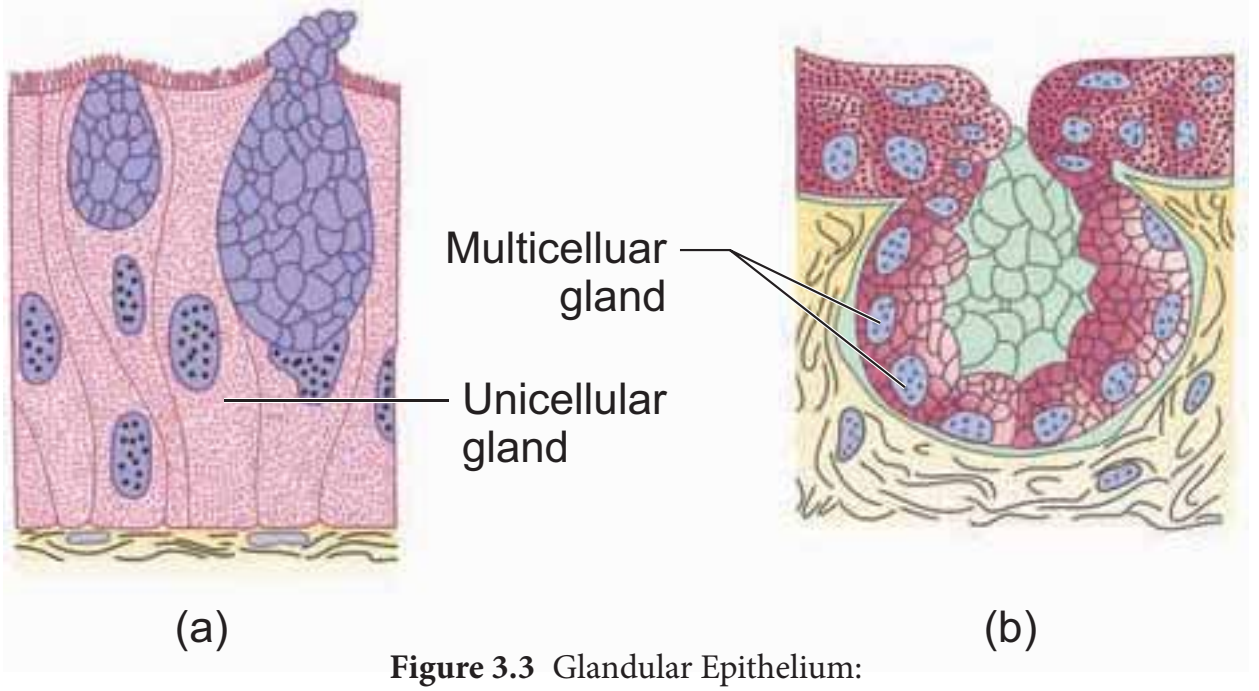


Figure 3.3 Glandular Epithelium:

through ducts or tubes. In contrast endocrine glands do not have ducts. Their secretions called hormones are secreted directly into the fluid bathing the gland. The exocrine glands are classified as unicellular and multicelluar glands. The multicelluar glands are further classified based on the structure as **simple** and **compound glands,** based on their secretory units as **tubular, alveolar (Acinus)** and **tubulo alveolar**. Based on the mode of secretion exocrine glands are classified as **merocrine, holocrine** and **apocrine**.

Compound epithelium is made of more than one layer (multi-layered) of cells and thus has a limited role in secretion and absorption(Figure 3.4). The compound epithelia may be stratified and transitional.

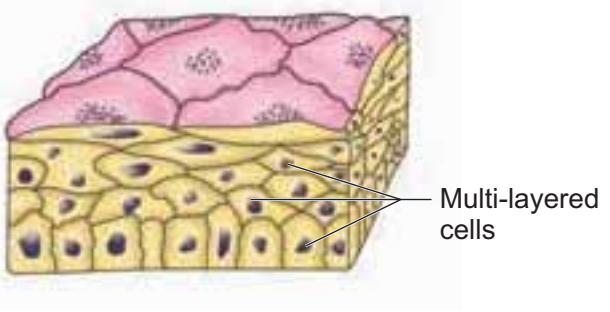


Figure 3.4 Compound Epithelium

Their main function is to provide protection against chemical and mechanical stresses. They cover the dry surface of the skin, the moist surface of buccal cavity, pharynx, inner lining of ducts of salivary glands and of pancreatic ducts. There are four types of compound epithelium namely, stratified squamous epithelium, cuboidal epithelium, columnar epithelium and transitional epithelium. **Stratified squamous epithelium** is of two types called **keratinized type** which forms the dry epidermis of the skin and the **non keratinized type** forms the moist lining of the oesophagus, mouth, conjunctiva of the eyes and vagina. **Stratified cuboidal epithelium** mostly found in the ducts of sweat glands and mammary glands. **Stratified columnar epithelium** has limited distribution in the body, found around the lumen of the pharynx, male urethra and lining of some glandular ducts.

Stratified epithelia are "built" for protection or to resist abrasion. What are the simple epithelia better at?